FAMILY AND SOCIETY IN ISLAM

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

GENERAL EDUCATION

DIHPE - DOW UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES (DUHS)

LECTURE# 5

PART (II)

MARRIAGE, FAMILY,

AND

GENDER ROLES IN MUSLIM SOCIETY

MARRIAGE

A Sacred Social Contract

- Marriage is a sacred social contract between a man and a woman. Like all great religions, Islam also emphasizes the institution of marriage.
- Allah says in the Holy Quran:
  - “And among His Signs is this, that He created for you mates from among yourselves, that ye may dwell in tranquility with them, and He has put love and mercy between your (hearts): verily in that are Signs for those who reflect.”

(Surah Ar-Rum,Verse:21)

Marriage as a Relationship of Protection and Intimacy

“They are your garments, and you are their garments.” (Surah Al-Baqarah, Verse:187)

The Qur’an uses the metaphor of “garments” to describe the intimate, protective, and dignified relationship between husband and wife.

Just as garments cover and beautify, so do spouses support and shield one another.

MARRIAGE IN ISLAM

Spiritual and Social Dimensions

Marriage in Islam is not just a legal bond; it is a spiritual and social union designed to provide:

1. Companionship
2. Moral stability
3. Fulfillment of natural desires in a lawful manner
4. Support for building an Islamic family and society

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ encouraged marriage to preserve modesty and avoid unlawful behavior.

He said: “The best wedding is that upon which the least trouble and expense is bestowed.” (Sunan Abu Dawud)

This Hadith encourages simplicity in marital practices and discourages extravagance.

KEY CONDITIONS OF A VALID MARRIAGE IN ISLAM

Key conditions of marriage in Islam include:

1. Proposal (Ijab) and Acceptance (Qubool) between the bride and groom
2. Mutual consent from both parties
3. Presence of two witnesses
4. Payment of Mahr (dower) by the groom to the bride
5. Public announcement of the Nikah to avoid secrecy

During the Nikah ceremony, a sermon (khutbah) is often delivered, reminding both spouses of:

1. Their duties to Allah
2. Their responsibilities to one another
3. The importance of living a God-conscious and responsible life

FAMILY

Family in Islam (Usrah) الأسرة

Definition and Meaning:

The Arabic word ‘Usrah’ (family) is derived from roots that denote:

Unity

Closeness

Protection

A family in Islam is defined as a group of people connected through strong, loving, and protective ties, maintaining cohesion and moral structure.

FAMILY

Importance of the Family Unit

- The family is a central component of Islamic society.
- All elements of a family—parents, children, spouses, and relatives are given due rights and responsibilities in Islam.
- The family system helps in shaping individuals who are morally upright, emotionally balanced, and spiritually aware.
- “O you who believe! Ward off from yourselves and your families a Fire (Hell)...” (Surah At-Tahrim, Vderse:6)

This verse shows that family responsibility includes spiritual guidance and protection.

FAMILY

Family: Foundation of Civilization

A sensible and well-balanced family system is the foundation of a happy life and the root of an advancing civilization.

Islamic teachings ensure that:

1. The rights of every family member are protected.
2. The family becomes a means of peace, emotional support, and religious growth.
3. Religion serves to bring individuals closer to Allah by guiding every aspect of human life, including marriage and family relations.

GENDER ROLES IN ISLAM

Foundational Principles:

In Islam, gender roles are grounded in the Quran, the Hadith (sayings and actions of Prophet Muhammad SAW), and Islamic jurisprudence. The fundamental principle is the spiritual equality of men and women.

Allah stated in the Surah An-Nahal verse 97:

"To whoever, male or female, does good deeds and has faith, We shall give a good life and reward them according to the best of their actions.."

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Men's Role

Providers:

Men are generally expected to be the primary financial providers for their families. This is rooted in the Quranic verse: "Men are the protectors and maintainers of women, because Allah has given the one more (strength) than the other, and because they support them from their means." (Quran 4:34)

Guardians:

Men are seen as guardians responsible for the well-being, security, and moral guidance of their families.

Leaders:

Men often assume leadership roles within the family and community, making decisions in consultation with their spouses and family members.

WOMEN'S ROLE

Homemakers:

Women are traditionally viewed as homemakers, managing household affairs and raising children. However, this role is not exclusively imposed, and women can seek employment and education.

Nurturers:

Women play a critical role in nurturing and educating children, teaching Islamic values and principles from an early age.

Supporters:

Women support their husbands and contribute to the family’s overall well-being, both emotionally and spiritually.

Modesty:

Women are instructed to be modest in their behavior and dress, as stated in Surah al Noor verse 31:

"And tell the believing women to lower their gaze and guard their chastity, and not to reveal their adornments- except what normally appears. Let them draw their veils over their chests, and not reveal their ˹hidden˺ adornments except to their husbands, their fathers, their fathers-in-law, their sons, their stepsons, their brothers, their brothers' sons or sisters' sons, their fellow women, those 'bondwomen' in their possession, male attendants with no desire, or children who are still unaware of women's nakedness. Let them not stomp their feet, drawing attention to their hidden adornments. Turn to Allah in repentance all together, O believers, so that you may be successful."

COMPLEMENTARY PARTNERSHIP

- Men and women are allies in fulfilling the purposes of family and society.
- Each has a unique role, but both are essential to a balanced life.
- The Prophet (SAW) consulted his wives in personal and public matters, showing that mutual respect and understanding are fundamental.

FLEXIBILITY AND MUTUAL RESPECT

- Islamic teachings emphasize mutual respect and cooperation between men and women, acknowledging their complementary roles in society and the family. While there are general guidelines, these roles can vary based on individual circumstances and cultural contexts.

THANK YOU